Windows logon types 2, 3, 4, 5, 7, 10 and 11: table with meaning and one normal vs one suspicious example.

Windows logon types identify the mechanism used to authenticate an account.

They are particularly important when analyzing successful and failed authentication events.

Logon Type	Name	Meaning	Normal Example	Suspicious Example
2	Interactive	User signs in directly at the computer	Employee signs in at their workstation	Unauthorized local login
3	Network	User or service accesses resources over the network	Accessing a shared folder	Unexpected administrative share access
4	Batch	Account logs on for batch processing	Scheduled backup job	Unknown scheduled task running with privileged credentials
5	Service	Account logs on to run a service	Legitimate database service startup	Unauthorized service running under a privileged account
7	Unlock	User unlocks an existing session	Employee unlocks their workstation	Unexpected unlock during an unattended period
10	Remote Interactive	User signs in through Remote Desktop or similar remote interactive access	Authorized administrator uses RDP	Unexpected remote desktop login
11	Cached Interactive	User signs in using cached domain credentials	Laptop user signs in without domain controller connectivity	Unexpected cached sign-in on an unfamiliar endpoint

❖ **Security Significance**

- Logon Type 2: Useful for identifying physical or console access to a system.
- Logon Type 3: Important for investigating network access, SMB authentication, and possible lateral movement.
- Logon Type 4: Helps identify scheduled-task activity and potentially malicious automated execution.
- Logon Type 5: Helps detect unusual service-account authentication.
- Logon Type 7: Useful when investigating workstation access and session activity.
- Logon Type 10: Important for monitoring Remote Desktop access and unauthorized remote interactive sessions.

- Logon Type 11: Helps identify authentication using locally cached domain credentials.

A logon type describes the authentication mechanism, not whether the activity is malicious.